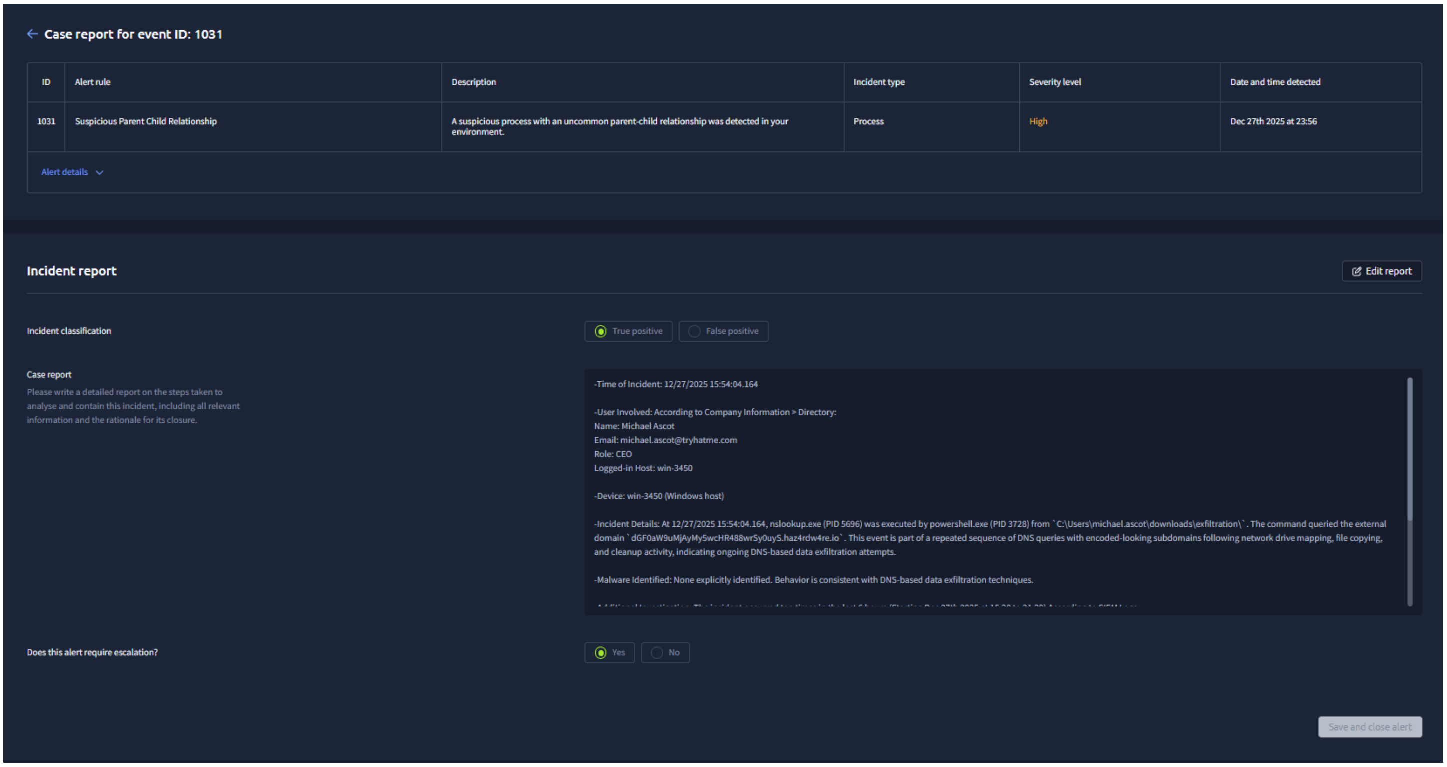
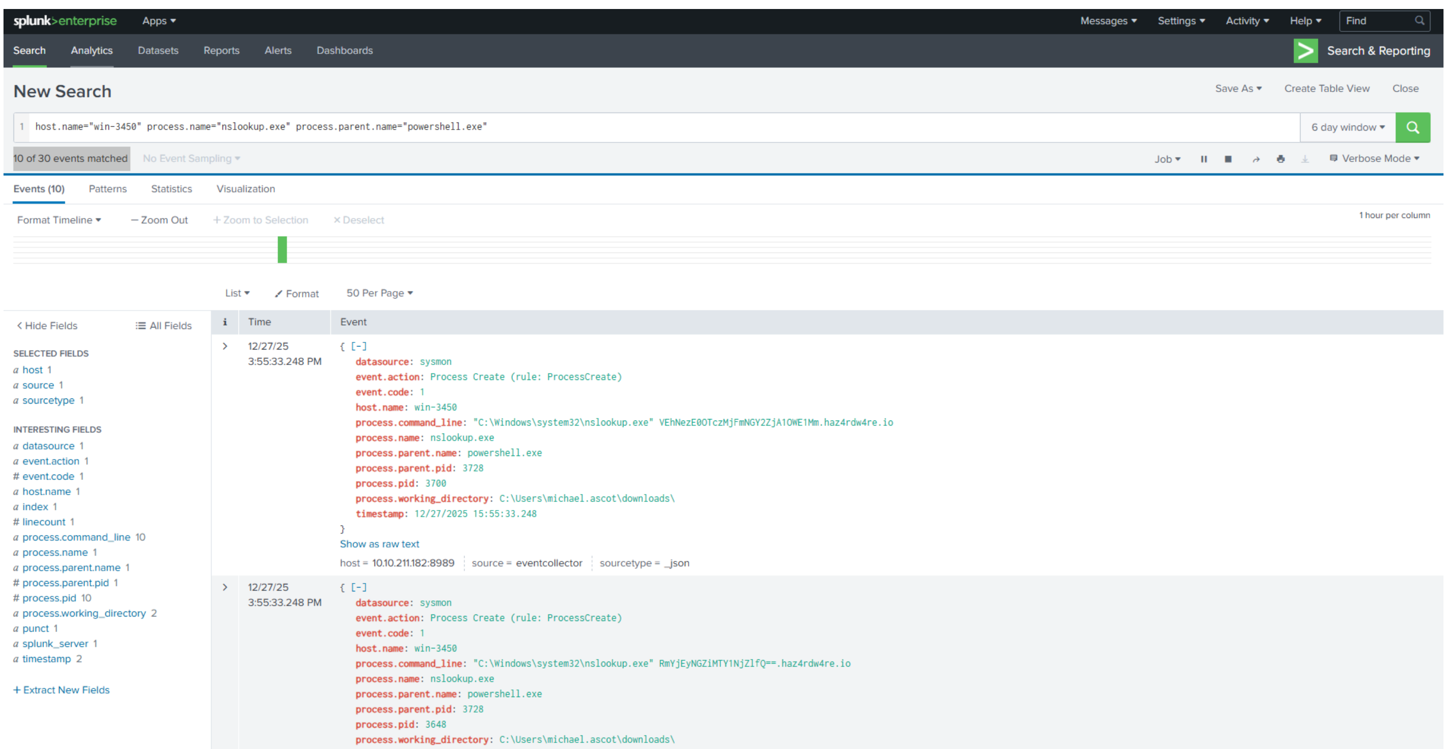


Alert 1031: Process

- Identified as True Positive
- Requires escalation to L2
- Full Report Documented on the last page



SIEM Investigation

- For reference: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:

Name: Michael Ascot
Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com
Role: CEO
Logged-in Host: win-3450
Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, nslookup.exe (PID 5696) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from `C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration\`. The command queried the external domain `dGF0aW9uMjAyMy5wcHR488wrSy0uyS.haz4rdw4re.io`. This event is part of a repeated sequence of DNS queries with encoded-looking subdomains following network drive mapping, file copying, and cleanup activity, indicating ongoing DNS-based data exfiltration attempts.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Behavior is consistent with DNS-based data exfiltration techniques.

-Additional Investigation: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20) According to SIEM Logs

-Additional info:

Parent Process: powershell.exe was used to automate and repeatedly execute DNS queries, indicating scripted and intentional behavior rather than normal user activity.

Child Process: nslookup.exe is a legitimate Windows DNS utility that can be abused to transmit encoded data via DNS requests to external domains.

Why This Is Uncommon: Generating multiple high-entropy DNS queries from a directory named “exfiltration,” initiated via PowerShell, is not typical system or user behavior and strongly aligns with covert data exfiltration patterns.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

-This is a True Positive

-This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation